SURVIVAL-TIPS

Disaster Risk Reduction (DRR)

Risk awareness, emergency preparedness, first aid, shelter, evacuation, and immediate survival.

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How to use this handbook

Use this guide as a learning aid, not as a substitute for official emergency instructions or expert assessment. Every AI-extracted tip must be reviewed before it is treated as verified guidance. Never infer that a wild plant, mushroom, water source, or improvised material is safe based on appearance alone.

1. Use Local, Sustainable Materials

Prioritize locally sourced, sustainably harvested materials for shelter construction to reduce transport costs, environmental impact, and support local economies.

Steps

1. Identify available local materials (wood, sand, etc.).
2. Assess sustainability and environmental impact.
3. Source materials responsibly.
4. Incorporate into shelter design.

Warnings

• Overharvesting can damage local ecosystems.

• Unsustainable sourcing may increase costs.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Emergency Shelter Solutions and Standards | UNHCR — https://emergency.unhcr.org/emergency-assistance/settlement-and-shelter/guidance-shelter/emergency-shelter-solutions-and-standards

2. Employ Plastic Sheeting as Primary Shelter Component

Use lightweight, UV-resistant plastic sheeting as the main covering for shelters, combined with rigid framing for flexibility and cost-effectiveness.

Steps

1. Acquire sufficient plastic sheeting.
2. Attach to framing or skeleton.
3. Seal edges with tape or staples.

Warnings

• Not wind-resistant; may fail in heavy rain or high winds.

• Improper disposal can harm the environment.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Emergency Shelter Solutions and Standards | UNHCR — https://emergency.unhcr.org/emergency-assistance/settlement-and-shelter/guidance-shelter/emergency-shelter-solutions-and-standards

3. Adhere to Minimum Covered Living Space Standards

Ensure shelters provide at least 3.5 m² per person in warm climates and 4.5–5.5 m² per person in cold climates to prevent overcrowding and maintain comfort.

Steps

1. Calculate required area per person.
2. Design shelter layout accordingly.
3. Verify compliance before occupancy.

Warnings

• Insufficient space leads to overcrowding and health risks.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Emergency Shelter Solutions and Standards | UNHCR — https://emergency.unhcr.org/emergency-assistance/settlement-and-shelter/guidance-shelter/emergency-shelter-solutions-and-standards

4. Maintain Minimum Shelter Height for Ventilation

Design shelters with a minimum of 2 m height at the lowest point to promote air circulation and reduce heat loss.

Steps

1. Set roof height to at least 2 m.
2. Ensure clearance for occupants and ventilation.
3. Adjust design for local climate if needed.

Warnings

• Low height reduces airflow and can cause condensation.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Emergency Shelter Solutions and Standards | UNHCR — https://emergency.unhcr.org/emergency-assistance/settlement-and-shelter/guidance-shelter/emergency-shelter-solutions-and-standards

5. Insulate and Seal Shelters in Cold Climates

Use plastic sheeting, tapes, and insulation on walls, roofs, and doors to retain heat and reduce wind and snow penetration.

Steps

1. Seal windows and doors with plastic sheeting and tape.
2. Insulate walls, ceilings, and floors.
3. Check for gaps and seal them.

Warnings

• Improper sealing can lead to fire hazards if heating sources are used.

• Insulation must be fire■rated.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Emergency Shelter Solutions and Standards | UNHCR — https://emergency.unhcr.org/emergency-assistance/settlement-and-shelter/guidance-shelter/emergency-shelter-solutions-and-standards

6. Clean Flood Water Inside and Outside the Home

Follow CDC cleanup guidelines to safely remove flood water and reduce health risks.

Steps

1. Wear protective gear (gloves, boots, mask).
2. Remove standing water using pumps or wet vacuums.
3. Dispose of contaminated water in accordance with local regulations.
4. Clean and disinfect surfaces with EPA■approved disinfectants.
5. Dry areas thoroughly to prevent mold.
6. Check for structural damage before re■occupying the space.

Warnings

• Avoid contact with flood water that may contain sewage or chemicals.

• Do not use contaminated water for cooking or drinking.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Responding to a Water, Sanitation, & Hygiene (WASH)-related Emergency | Water, Sanitation, & Hygiene-related Emergencies & and Outbreaks | Healthy Water | CDC — https://archive.cdc.gov/www_cdc_gov/healthywater/emergency/planning-training-response/responding.html

7. Use the Environmental Health Shelter Assessment Tool

Employ CDC’s 14■area assessment form to quickly evaluate shelter conditions during emergencies.

Steps

1. Download the Environmental Health Shelter Assessment Tool.
2. Conduct a rapid assessment covering food safety, water quality, sanitation, etc.
3. Document findings and immediate needs.
4. Prioritize interventions based on assessment results.
5. Re■assess after changes are made.

Warnings

• Ensure the tool is adapted to local context before use.

• Do not rely solely on the tool; use professional judgment.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Responding to a Water, Sanitation, & Hygiene (WASH)-related Emergency | Water, Sanitation, & Hygiene-related Emergencies & and Outbreaks | Healthy Water | CDC — https://archive.cdc.gov/www_cdc_gov/healthywater/emergency/planning-training-response/responding.html

8. Apply Infection Control Guidance in Evacuation Centers

Implement CDC infection control recommendations to prevent disease spread in temporary community evacuation centers.

Steps

1. Set up handwashing stations with soap and water.
2. Provide hand sanitizer where water is scarce.
3. Ensure proper waste disposal and sanitation facilities.
4. Educate residents on hygiene practices.
5. Monitor for signs of illness and isolate if necessary.

Warnings

• Do not neglect ventilation, which can spread airborne pathogens.

• Avoid overcrowding of sanitation facilities.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Responding to a Water, Sanitation, & Hygiene (WASH)-related Emergency | Water, Sanitation, & Hygiene-related Emergencies & and Outbreaks | Healthy Water | CDC — https://archive.cdc.gov/www_cdc_gov/healthywater/emergency/planning-training-response/responding.html

9. Prepare for Hurricane Evacuation

Know evacuation routes and how to reach them quickly if instructed.

Steps

1. Identify nearest evacuation shelters
2. Map out fastest routes
3. Ensure family members know the plan

Warnings

• Evacuate promptly if ordered

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Plan Ahead for Disasters | Ready.gov — https://www.ready.gov/

10. Avoid Flooded Roads and Walkways

If you encounter a flooded path, turn around to avoid drowning.

Steps

1. Check water depth
2. If water is visible, do not cross
3. Seek higher ground

Warnings

• Do not attempt to cross flooded areas

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Plan Ahead for Disasters | Ready.gov — https://www.ready.gov/

11. Build an Emergency Kit

Stock your kit with essential items for emergencies.

Steps

1. Include water, food, first aid, flashlight, batteries
2. Add personal documents
3. Check expiration dates regularly

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Plan Ahead for Disasters | Ready.gov — https://www.ready.gov/

12. Download the FEMA Mobile App

Use the FEMA app for preparedness strategies and real■time alerts.

Steps

1. Install the FEMA app
2. Enable notifications
3. Review preparedness guides

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Plan Ahead for Disasters | Ready.gov — https://www.ready.gov/

13. Define Clear Objectives for Your Home Garden

List the main outputs you want and the constraints you face to guide improvement decisions.

Steps

1. Write a list of the main things you want your home garden to produce.
2. Identify major constraints such as wild pigs, poor soil or sloping land.

Review status: needs_review • Category: planning

Source: Improving nutrition through home gardening - A training package for preparing field workers in Southeast Asia — https://www.fao.org/4/V5290E/v5290e04.htm